Benjamin Rucker

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Experience

Software Engineer @ Palantir Technologies — Aug 2022 – Present

Mission Planning *Multi-user Gantt scheduling app with real-time sync on Foundry.* — Jan 2025 – Present

- Built the app with 2 other engineers, a PM, and a designer from first commit to GA in 6 months.
  - Zero outages with 6,000 weekly active users and hundreds of plan authors.
- Integrated the Commands framework from the start so AIP Agents build and repair plans through the UI's own commands.
- Maintain the org-wide AGENTS.md: cut its tokens by 57%, fixed its i18n rules so agents stopped inventing translations.
- Shipped an internal-doc leakage eval for the help channel's LLM bot and upgraded its system prompt.
- Own the write path into customer-configured data models (Ontologies): rewrote validation for many-to-many links so one event can be fulfilled by multiple resources; ran new against old, logging discrepancies; launched with no breaking change.
- Built the scheduling interactions (drag, resize, duplicate, inline edit) with live preview.
- Shipped the view layer as an embeddable component, now in production in Gaia and Workshop (Foundry's app builder); built per-user theme sync across apps, replacing unconfigurable per-app theming.
- Wrote the style guide and run the weekly frontend meeting; reviewed every PR through GA; 1,500 PRs total.

Gaia *Geospatial mapping application for defense.* — Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Split 22 packages out of Gaia's monolith, restoring TypeScript language-server functionality in them.
- Established a code extraction pattern adopted by 6 teammates. Their extractions grew from 7,000 lines in the 6 months before I joined to 43,000 in the 6 months after, excluding my commits.
- Shipped variable-speed route drawing and configurable minimap tile sets end-to-end: schema, API, and frontend.

Workflow Builder *Visual editor for the Ontology and its write-back Actions.* — May 2024 – Aug 2024

- Built a bulk function upgrade helper: an FDE can upgrade all of their function-calling Actions (commonly hundreds) with one click, saving them hours of work per week.
- Joined as the team's second engineer; shipped read-only mode and the Action edit view, which covers security policies and implementation; made the Figma mocks on a team with no designer.

Object Views *Entity detail UI in Gotham, especially for intelligence analysts.* — Aug 2022 – Apr 2024

- Shipped a panel that filters a host app's selection, tiled in Electron, unblocking further migration off Java Swing.
- Owned undo for entity merges from design through analyst feedback to ship.
- Built shared theme infrastructure for a new dialog; a first version broke 4 apps and was reverted before release; migrated all 7 apps across 4 teams myself, coordinating with each team.
- Wrote shared utilities with 700 call sites across Gotham.
- Migrated 2 map frontends onto a new tile-serving backend.

Across teams:

- Conducted 78 live-coding interviews since Aug 2023; mentored an engineer who is now a tech lead, onboarded 3 others.
- Field user questions in all 4 teams' help channels; added debug-panel features in Mission Planning to answer them faster.
- Hackweek: built a VS Code extension that extracts selected JSX into a component with its CSS; 2 teammates adopted it.

Projects

JermaBot *github.com/benrucker/JermaBot* — 2019 – Present

- Self-host a Discord bot in 98 servers with 2,500 combined members; its soundboards and join sounds predate Discord's.
- Embedded an experimental agent built on the Claude Agent SDK that opens PRs on my repos from Discord; it runs in a sandbox with a restricted tool set and allowlisted write paths, and 5 of its PRs have merged.

whid10 *ruck.dev/whid10* — 2025 – 2026

- Led a team of 5 as PM, lead developer, and designer on a Discord community's 10-year anniversary site (Next.js, Convex).
- Designed 5 of 7 exhibits, each with a distinct theme, layout, and tech; CSS, vector graphics, a WebGL shader, and more.
- Built the Pandas and Marimo pipeline to turn 440,000 messages into around 57,000 datapoints.
- Made privacy a requirement: gated the site behind Discord OAuth and made private data server-rendered.

Education

B.S. Computer Science, University of Pittsburgh — Apr 2022

Skills

TypeScript, React, Redux, Java, Next.js, Node.js, Python, WebGL, Figma, Claude Agent SDK